

ARCHITECTURAL / 2022 / CHICAGO, IL

Grand Spiral Stair

Uber Freight HQ, Old Post Office



A sixteen foot diameter stair finished in a custom blue toned patina, inspired by the building's historical spiral mail chutes.

THE WORK

The Old Post Office once moved letters through spiral mail chutes. The Grand Spiral Stair, at the center of Uber Freight's headquarters, takes its geometry from them. Next to a photograph of the original chutes the reference is obvious. On its own it reads as one spiraling band moving through the building, and that is how most people meet it.

THE MATERIAL QUESTION

A sixteen foot helix inside a landmark had to be structure, circulation, and finish at once, and the finish had to belong to a century-old interior rather than sit on top of it.

THE MAKING

Fabricated steel, produced with Gensler Chicago and Parenti & Raffaelli, finished in a custom blue toned patina that reads close to oil rubbed bronze. An infinity mirror at the top carries the spiral on past the ceiling.

IN PLACE

It was ChiLab's first union job and our first large-scale installation in a historic building, one of two pieces we built for Uber Freight's headquarters.

DETAILS

Year

2022

Location

Chicago, IL

Category

Architectural

Materials

Fabricated steel, custom blue patina, mirror

CREDITS

Architect: Gensler Chicago

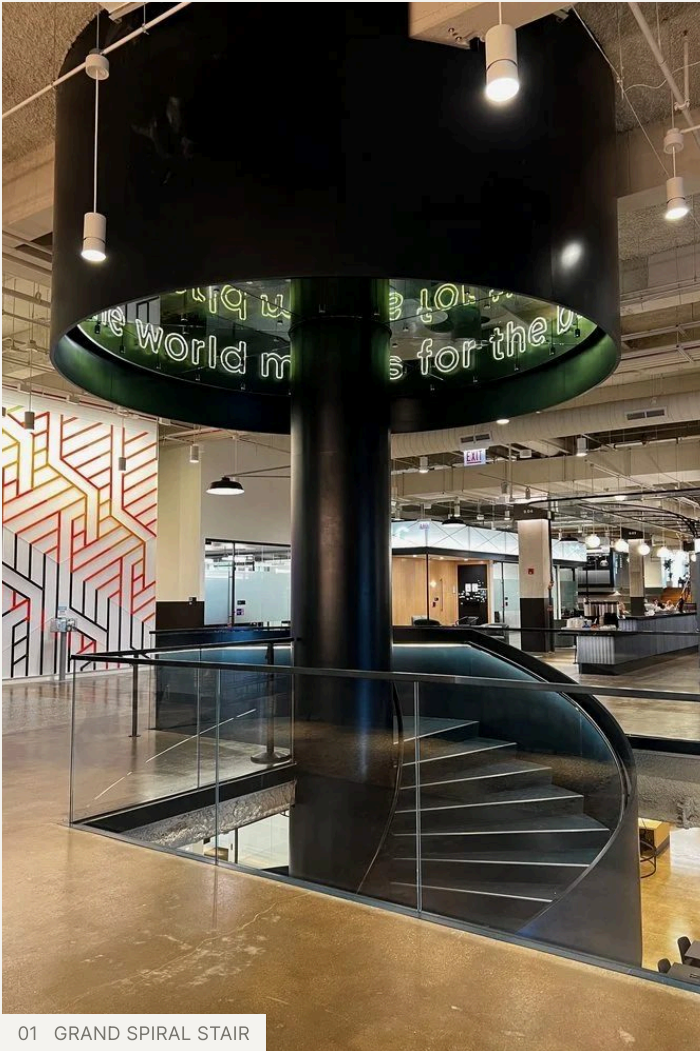
Fabrication partner: Parenti & Raffaelli

STUDIO

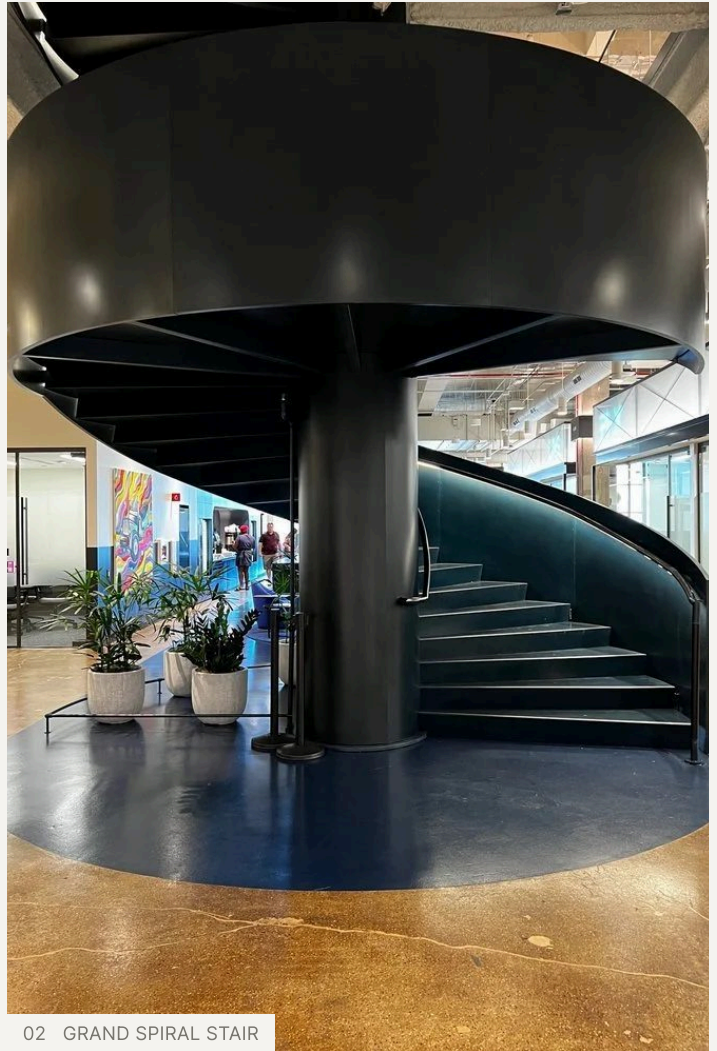
ChiLab Studio

Chicago, Illinois

Established 2013



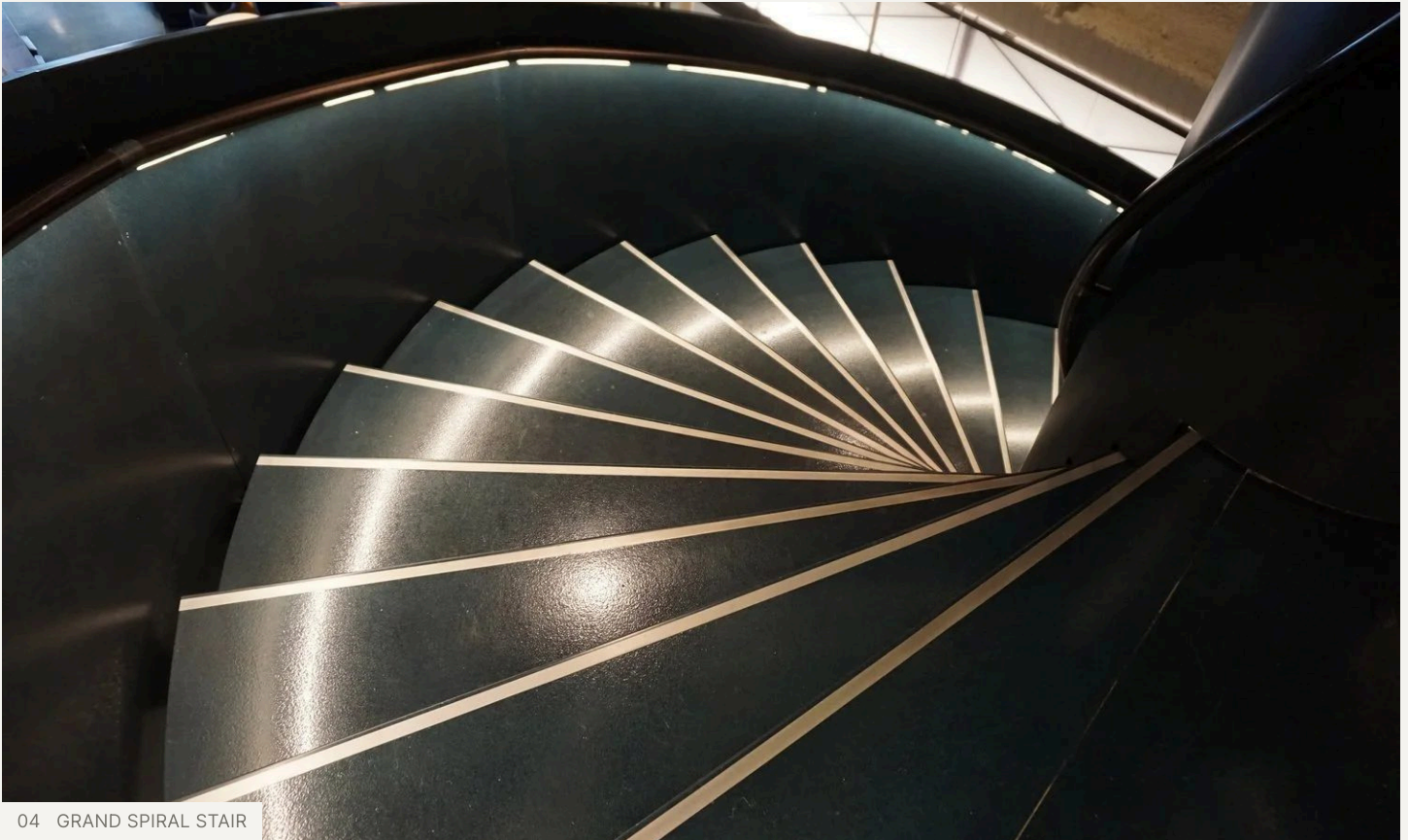
01 GRAND SPIRAL STAIR



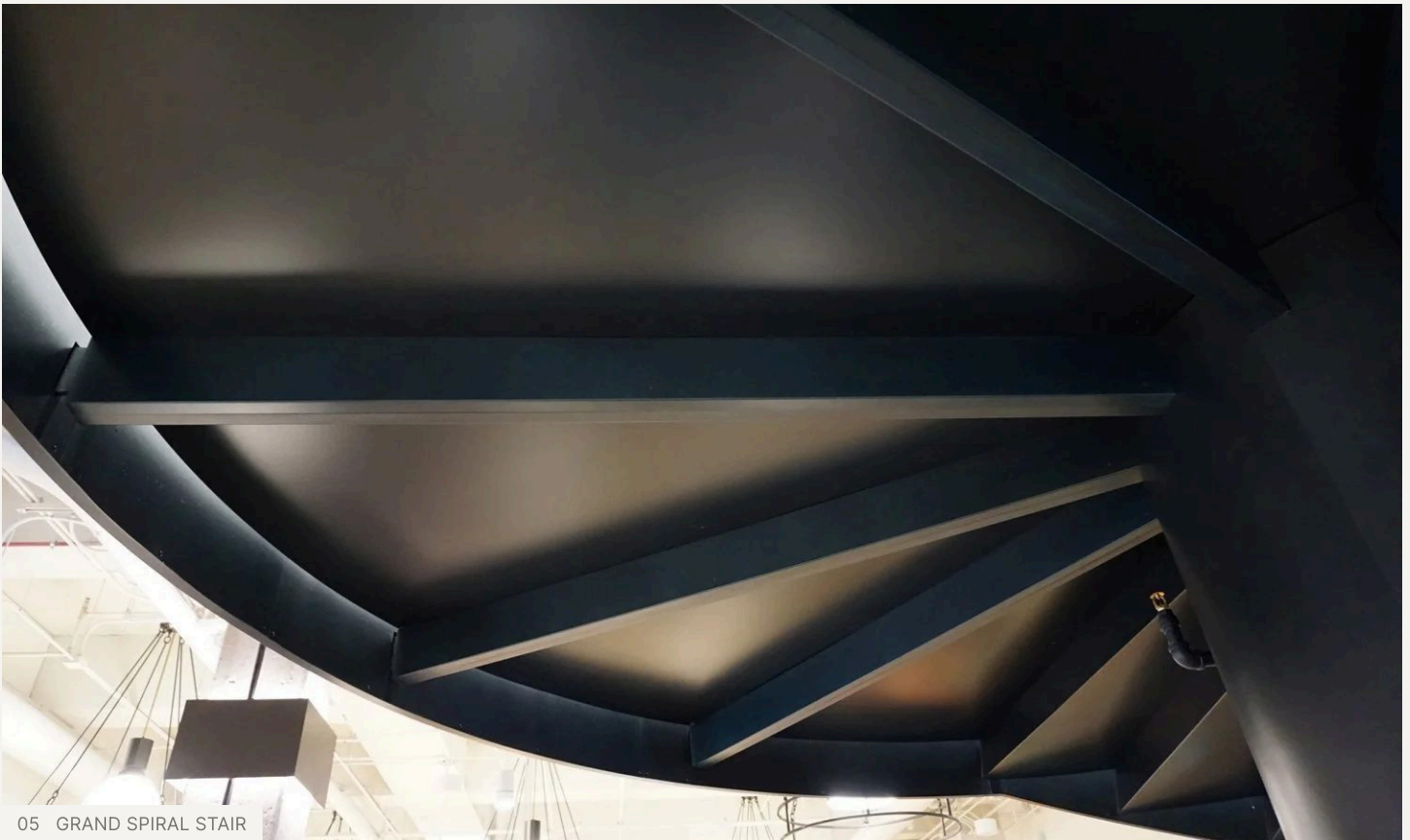
02 GRAND SPIRAL STAIR



03 GRAND SPIRAL STAIR



04 GRAND SPIRAL STAIR



05 GRAND SPIRAL STAIR

Bring us a drawing, a model, or a hunch.

THE STUDIO

Specialty material projects for architecture, interior design, public art, and the fine arts.

ChiLab Studio, Chicago, Illinois. Established 2013.

WHAT WE DO

Metal casting

Glass

Finishes

Digital fabrication

Metal fabrication

Restoration

Project management

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